

Barack Obama: Will He Smile for Us?

FEBRUARY 2, 2009

What does Barack Obama's presidency mean for India and its relations with the US? How will he handle India's confrontation with Pakistan over the Mumbai attacks or deal with the Kashmir issue? Will he be good for India?



“The change of guard in the US is very significant, but India needs to tread cautiously and change its approach, strategy and thinking. In short, be ready to expect the unexpected.”

ANIL VARADE, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Canny Leader

US President Barack Obama's statement on the "shared values" between America and India that can help us meet any challenges, particularly from those who "use violence to try to undermine our free and open societies", makes us believe that he understands and shares India's deep concerns about the common enemy—the jihadis ("Good for Us", February 2). It also reflects his firm determination on tackling the war on terror by taking it to a logical conclusion. **M.C. JOSHI,**
via www.indiatoday.in

As Barack Obama takes over the reins of the most powerful country in the world, there is an unenviable expectation from the man to solve all the



BANDEEP SINGH

Time to Act

Compared to the rest of the world, we are doing all right ("It Will Get Worse", February 2). However, the slump in oil prices has prompted the freezing of a number of development and tourism projects across the Middle East, further worsening the employment scene there. The current fiscal scenario will affect most countries in the world, especially those that greatly depend on trade and tourism for their survival. We need to be prepared.

RAMACHANDRAN NAIR, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Most of the sectors have been hit by recession and the Government needs to act at many levels to save the economy from bleeding. And it better act fast. **J.S. ACHARYA,** *via www.indiatoday.in*

world's ills. His cautious tone as he addressed the nation seemed to indicate his wariness. Obama wants to ensure that all such expectations stay within the realm of reality and he tried to present a realistic picture of achievements before a nation that is deifying him and a world that expects a lot from him. Having said that, Obama now has to prove that he can actually walk the talk. His time has begun.

DR KARAN THAKUR,
via www.indiatoday.in

India's interests lie in Obama's stance with regard to Pak-based terrorists and Pakistan and he put all such fears to rest when he said: "If Pakistan does not act against its terrorists, then we will have to act." With this assur-

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